Taha Merghani

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Algorithmic fairness, human judgment in AI-assisted decisions, and language variation.

EDUCATION

M.S. in Computer Science, Georgia Institute of Technology, 2019. GPA 3.87/4.00.

B.S. in Computer Engineering, Jackson State University, 2017. GPA 4.00/4.00.

WORKSHOP PAPERS AND RESEARCH POSTER

Balusu, Murali Raghu Babu, **Taha Merghani**, and Jacob Eisenstein. "Stylistic Variation in Social Media Part-of-Speech Tagging." *Second Workshop on Stylistic Variation at NAACL*, 2018. Paper

Merghani, Taha. "Application of Hilbert-Schmidt Independence Criterion to Lexical Geographical Variation in Lyon, France." *Black in AI Workshop at NeurIPS*, 2018. Manuscript

Merghani, Taha, Tuka Al Hanai, and James Glass. "Lexical Modeling of Egyptian Arabic for Automatic Speech Recognition." MIT CSAIL research poster, 2015. Poster

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Georgia Tech | 2017-2019
Studied language variation across social networks and geography with Jacob Eisenstein. Worked on collaborative story generation with Mark Riedl.

Research Intern, MIT CSAIL | Summer 2015
Compared pronunciation dictionaries and acoustic models on Egyptian Arabic broadcast speech with Tuka Al Hanai and James Glass.

SELECTED ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Solutions Architect, Mesa Associates | 2022-2023
Built computer vision workflows for utility inspection using drone imagery.

AI Software Engineer, Decooda | 2019-2020
Built data pipelines and implemented machine learning workflows for customer analytics.

Software Engineering Intern, Apple Siri | Summer 2016
Built debugging tools for multilingual language understanding used by 120+ engineers.

HONORS

Jacksonian Award of Distinction, Jackson State University (2017). Apple HBCU Scholar and Distinguished Intern presenter (2016).